

# Masked Trajectory Models for Prediction, Representation, and Control

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# Introduction

This paper introduces Masked Trajectory Models (MTM) as a generic abstraction for sequential decision making.

- Self-supervised learning: takes a trajectory and aims to **reconstruct** the trajectory
- Training method: randomized masking
- **Versatile** capabilities: forward dynamics model, inverse dynamics model, offline RL agent

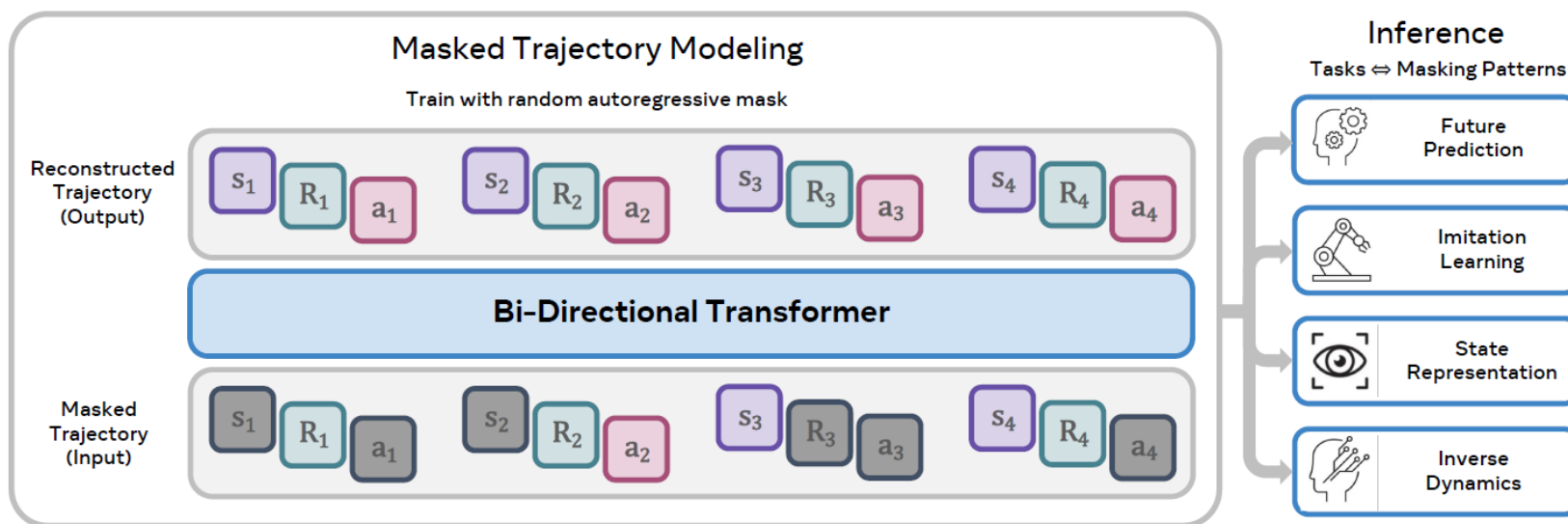
# Motivation

Previous paradigms necessitate integration of **multiple components** to obtain decision-making policies:

- Model-based RL: world models
- Actor-critic methods: critics
- Stabilization techniques

Goal: borrow the success from self-supervised learning (**masked prediction**) and **transformer** sequence models, to create a **generic and versatile** models

# Method



**Figure 1. Masked Trajectory Modeling (MTM) Framework.** (Left) The training process involves reconstructing trajectory segments from a randomly masked view of the same. (Right) After training, MTM can enable several downstream use-cases by simply changing the masking pattern at inference time. See Section 3 for discussion on training and inference masking patterns.

Trajectory  $\tau := (s_k, a_k, s_{k+1}, a_{k+1}, \dots, s_t, a_t)$

Reconstruction  $\hat{\tau} = h_{\theta}(\text{Masked}(\tau))$

- Masked( $\tau$ ):  $(s_k, \dots, a_{k+1}, \dots, s_t, \dots)$   $h_{\theta}$ : MTM

- One Model, Many Capabilities
- Heteromodality
- Data Efficiency
- Representation Learning

# Method

Trajectory with  $M$  different modalities:

$$\tau = \{(x_1^1, x_1^2, \dots, x_1^M), \dots, (x_T^1, x_T^2, \dots, x_T^M)\}$$

Modality-specific encoders:

$$z_t^m = E_\theta^m(x_t^m), \forall t \in [1, T], m \in [1, M]$$

Embedded/tokenized trajectory:

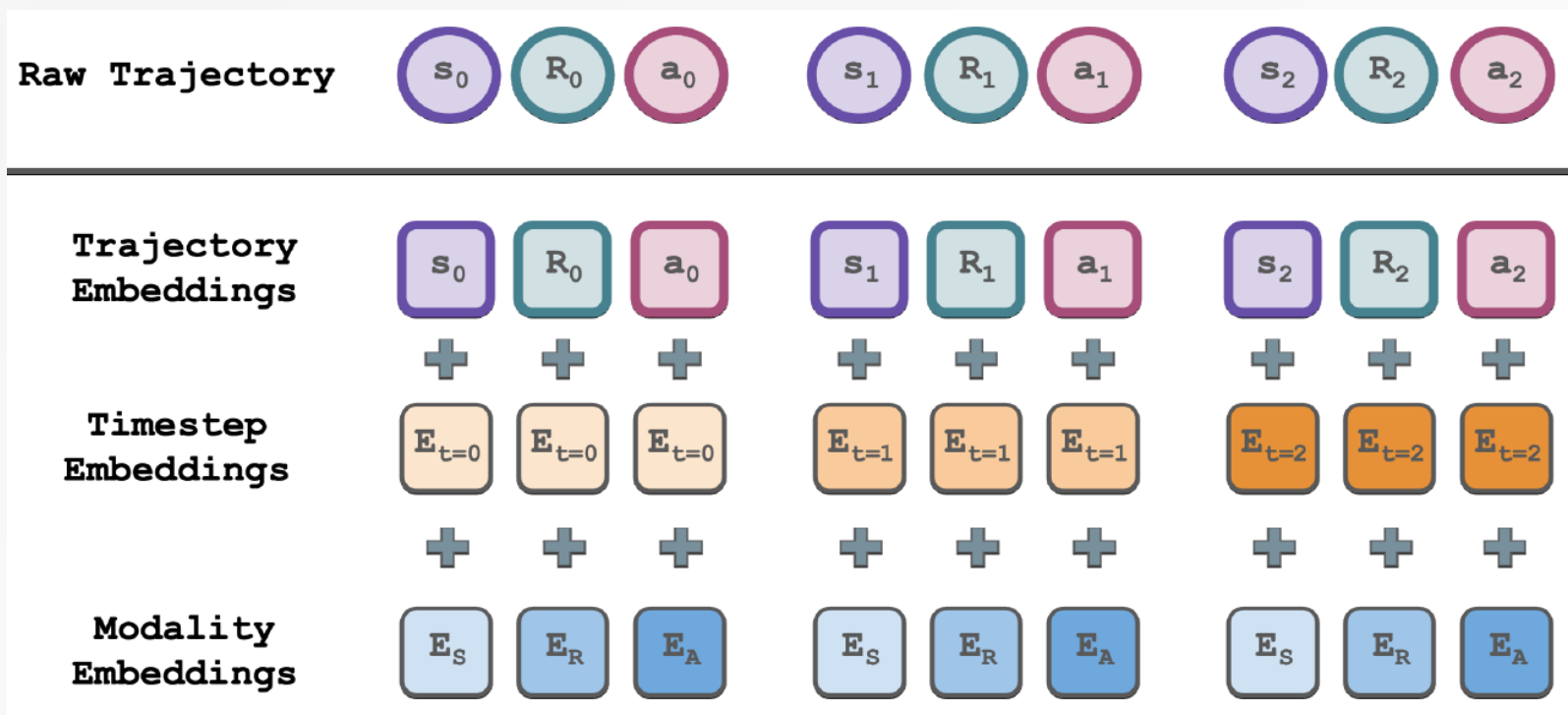
$$\tau = (z_1^1, z_1^2, \dots, z_1^M, \dots, z_t^m, \dots, z_T^M)$$

Learning objective:

$$\max_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{\tau} \sum_{t=1}^T \sum_{m=1}^M \log P_{\theta}(z_t^m | \text{Masked}(\tau))$$

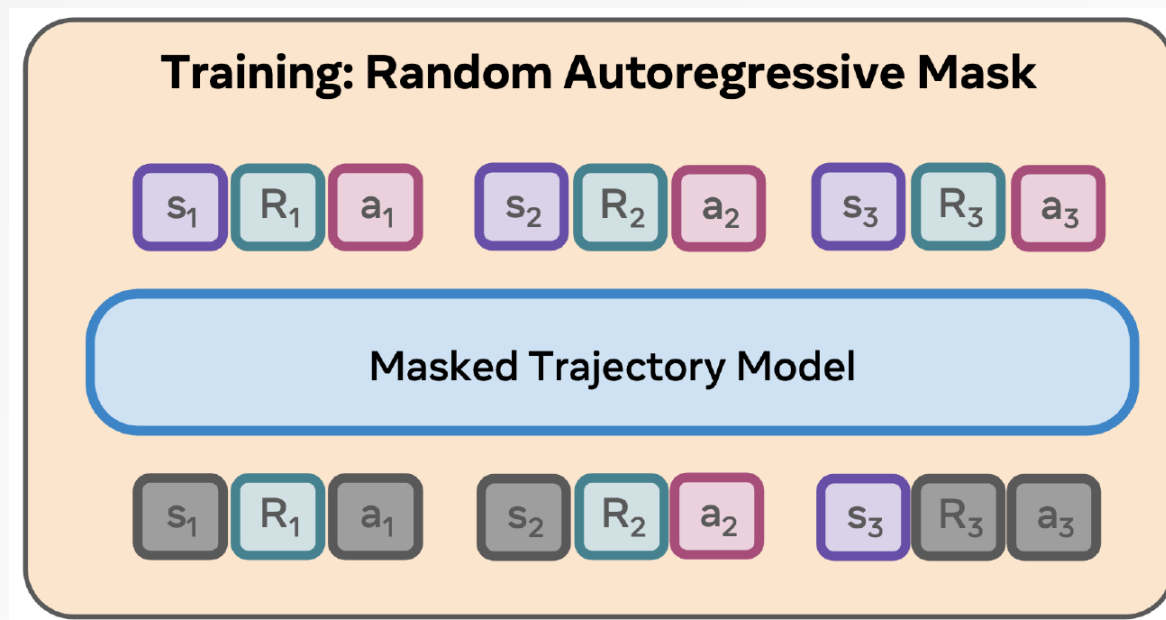
# Method

Embeddings: additionally add **timestep** embeddings and **modality type** embeddings.



# Method

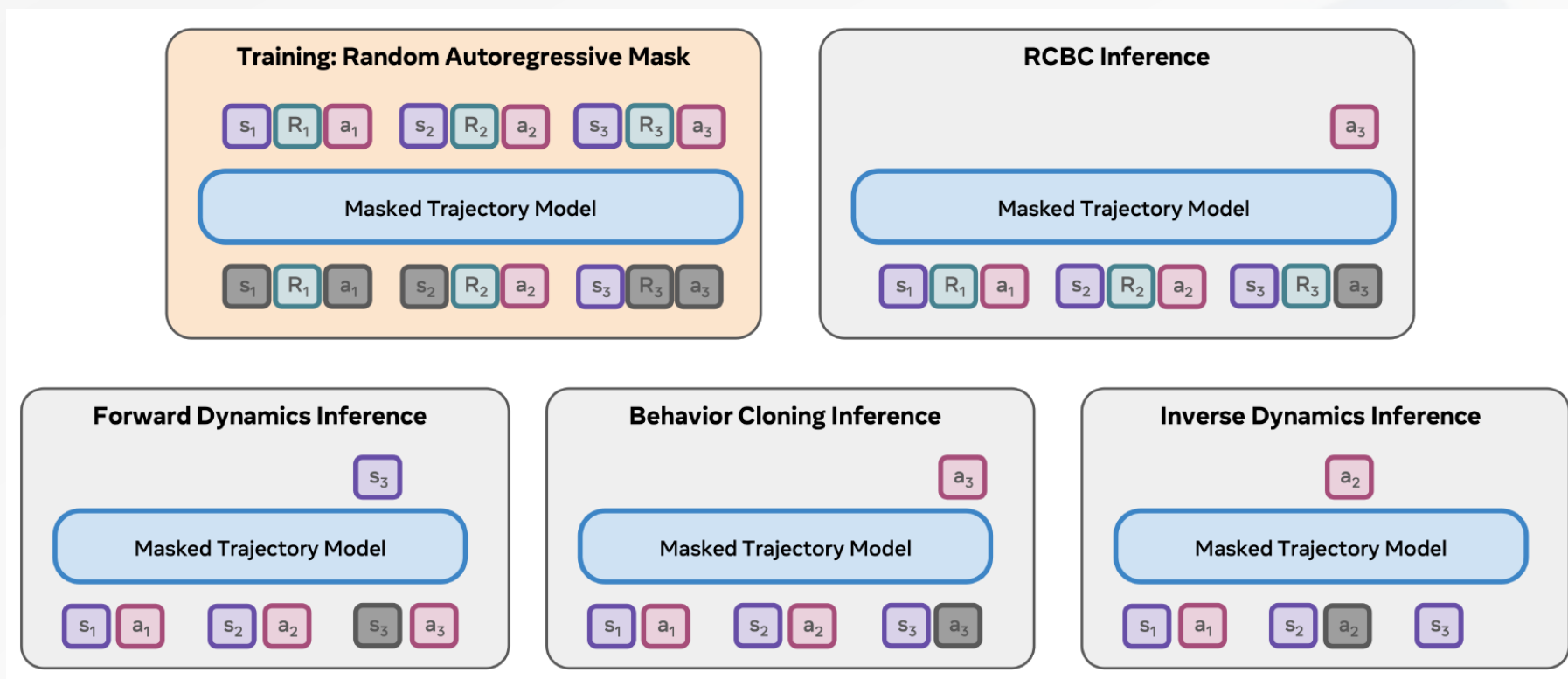
Masking Pattern: random **autoregressive** masking.



At least one masked token must have no future unmasked tokens. This means the **last element** in the sequence must necessarily be **masked**.

# Method

Versatility: Once trained, the MTM network can take on different roles by simply using **different masking patterns at inference time**.





# Experiments

## Offline RL results

**Table 1. Results on D4RL.** Offline RL results on the V2 locomotion suite of D4RL are reported here, specified by the normalized score as described in [Fu et al. \(2020\)](#). We find that MTM outperforms RvS and DT, which also use RCBC for offline RL.

| Environment | Dataset       | BC    | CQL   | IQL   | TT    | MOPO | RsV   | DT    | MTM (Ours) |
|-------------|---------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|------|-------|-------|------------|
| HalfCheetah | Medium-Replay | 36.6  | 45.5  | 44.2  | 41.9  | 42.3 | 38.0  | 36.6  | 43.0       |
| Hopper      | Medium-Replay | 18.1  | 95.0  | 94.7  | 91.5  | 28.0 | 73.5  | 82.7  | 92.9       |
| Walker2d    | Medium-Replay | 26.0  | 77.2  | 73.9  | 82.6  | 17.8 | 60.6  | 66.6  | 77.3       |
| HalfCheetah | Medium        | 42.6  | 44.0  | 47.4  | 46.9  | 53.1 | 41.6  | 42.0  | 43.6       |
| Hopper      | Medium        | 52.9  | 58.5  | 66.3  | 61.1  | 67.5 | 60.2  | 67.6  | 64.1       |
| Walker2d    | Medium        | 75.3  | 72.5  | 78.3  | 79.0  | 39.0 | 71.7  | 74.0  | 70.4       |
| HalfCheetah | Medium-Expert | 55.2  | 91.6  | 86.7  | 95.0  | 63.7 | 92.2  | 86.8  | 94.7       |
| Hopper      | Medium-Expert | 52.5  | 105.4 | 91.5  | 110.0 | 23.7 | 101.7 | 107.6 | 112.4      |
| Walker2d    | Medium-Expert | 107.5 | 108.8 | 109.6 | 101.9 | 44.6 | 106.0 | 108.1 | 110.2      |
| Average     |               | 51.9  | 77.6  | 77.0  | 78.9  | 42.2 | 71.7  | 74.7  | 78.7       |

MTM uses Return Conditioned Behavior Cloning (RCBC) mask

# Experiments

## MTM Capabilities

**Table 2. Evaluation of various MTM capabilities.** MTM refers to the model trained with the random autoregressive mask, and evaluated using the appropriate mask at inference time. S-MTM (“Specialized”) refers to the model that uses the appropriate mask both during training and inference time. We also compare with a specialized MLP baseline trained separately for each capability. Note that higher is better for BC and RCBC, while lower is better for FD and ID. We find that MTM is often comparable or better than training on specialized masking patterns, or training specialized MLPs. We use a box outline to indicate that a single model was used for all the evaluations within it. The right most column indicates if MTM is comparable or better than S-MTM, and we find this to be true in most cases.

| Domain         | Dataset       | Task                | MLP               | S-MTM (Ours)      | MTM (Ours)        | (MTM) $\gtrsim$ (S-MTM)? |
|----------------|---------------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|
| D4RL<br>Hopper | Expert        | ( $\uparrow$ ) BC   | 111.14 $\pm$ 0.33 | 111.81 $\pm$ 0.18 | 107.35 $\pm$ 7.77 | ✓                        |
|                | Expert        | ( $\uparrow$ ) RCBC | 111.17 $\pm$ 0.56 | 112.64 $\pm$ 0.47 | 112.49 $\pm$ 0.37 | ✓                        |
|                | Expert        | ( $\downarrow$ ) ID | 0.009 $\pm$ 0.000 | 0.013 $\pm$ 0.000 | 0.050 $\pm$ 0.026 | ✗                        |
|                | Expert        | ( $\downarrow$ ) FD | 0.072 $\pm$ 0.000 | 0.517 $\pm$ 0.025 | 0.088 $\pm$ 0.049 | ✓                        |
| D4RL<br>Hopper | Medium Replay | ( $\uparrow$ ) BC   | 35.63 $\pm$ 6.27  | 36.17 $\pm$ 4.09  | 29.46 $\pm$ 6.74  | ✗                        |
|                | Medium Replay | ( $\uparrow$ ) RCBC | 88.61 $\pm$ 1.68  | 93.30 $\pm$ 0.33  | 92.95 $\pm$ 1.51  | ✓                        |
|                | Medium Replay | ( $\downarrow$ ) ID | 0.240 $\pm$ 0.028 | 0.219 $\pm$ 0.008 | 0.534 $\pm$ 0.009 | ✗                        |
|                | Medium Replay | ( $\downarrow$ ) FD | 2.179 $\pm$ 0.052 | 3.310 $\pm$ 0.425 | 0.493 $\pm$ 0.030 | ✓                        |
| Adroit<br>Pen  | Expert        | ( $\uparrow$ ) BC   | 62.75 $\pm$ 1.43  | 66.28 $\pm$ 3.28  | 61.25 $\pm$ 5.06  | ✓                        |
|                | Expert        | ( $\uparrow$ ) RCBC | 68.41 $\pm$ 2.27  | 66.29 $\pm$ 1.39  | 64.81 $\pm$ 1.70  | ✓                        |
|                | Expert        | ( $\downarrow$ ) ID | 0.128 $\pm$ 0.001 | 0.155 $\pm$ 0.001 | 0.331 $\pm$ 0.049 | ✗                        |
|                | Expert        | ( $\downarrow$ ) FD | 0.048 $\pm$ 0.002 | 0.360 $\pm$ 0.020 | 0.321 $\pm$ 0.048 | ✓                        |
| Adroit<br>Pen  | Medium Replay | ( $\uparrow$ ) BC   | 33.73 $\pm$ 1.00  | 54.84 $\pm$ 5.08  | 47.10 $\pm$ 7.13  | ✗                        |
|                | Medium Replay | ( $\uparrow$ ) RCBC | 41.26 $\pm$ 4.99  | 57.50 $\pm$ 3.76  | 58.76 $\pm$ 5.63  | ✓                        |
|                | Medium Replay | ( $\downarrow$ ) ID | 0.308 $\pm$ 0.004 | 0.238 $\pm$ 0.004 | 0.410 $\pm$ 0.064 | ✓                        |
|                | Medium Replay | ( $\downarrow$ ) FD | 0.657 $\pm$ 0.023 | 0.915 $\pm$ 0.007 | 0.925 $\pm$ 0.026 | ✓                        |

S-MTM, trains a **specialized** model for each capability using the **corresponding masking** pattern at train time.

Behavior Cloning (BC): **Predict next action** given state-action history.

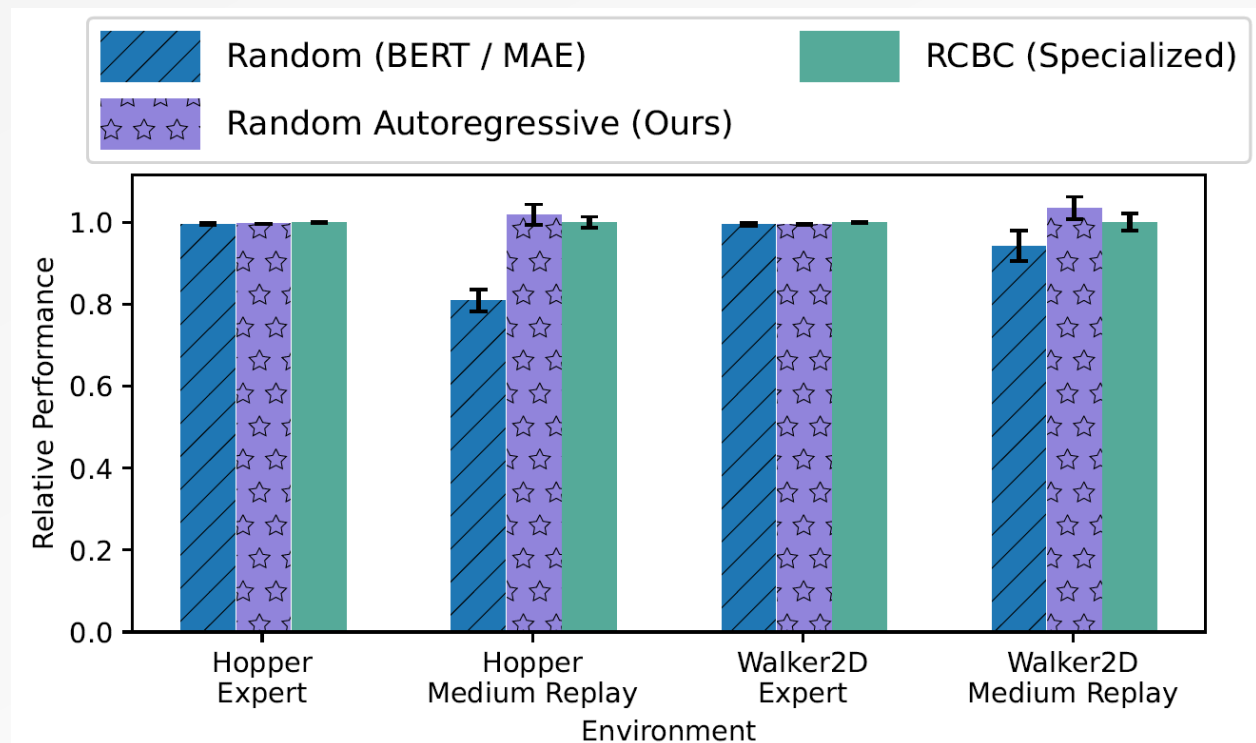
Return Conditioned Behavior Cloning (RCBC): similar to BC, additionally conditions on the desired **Return-to-Go**.

Inverse Dynamics (ID): **predict the action** using the current and future desired state.

Forward Dynamics (FD): **predict the next state** given history and current action.

# Experiments

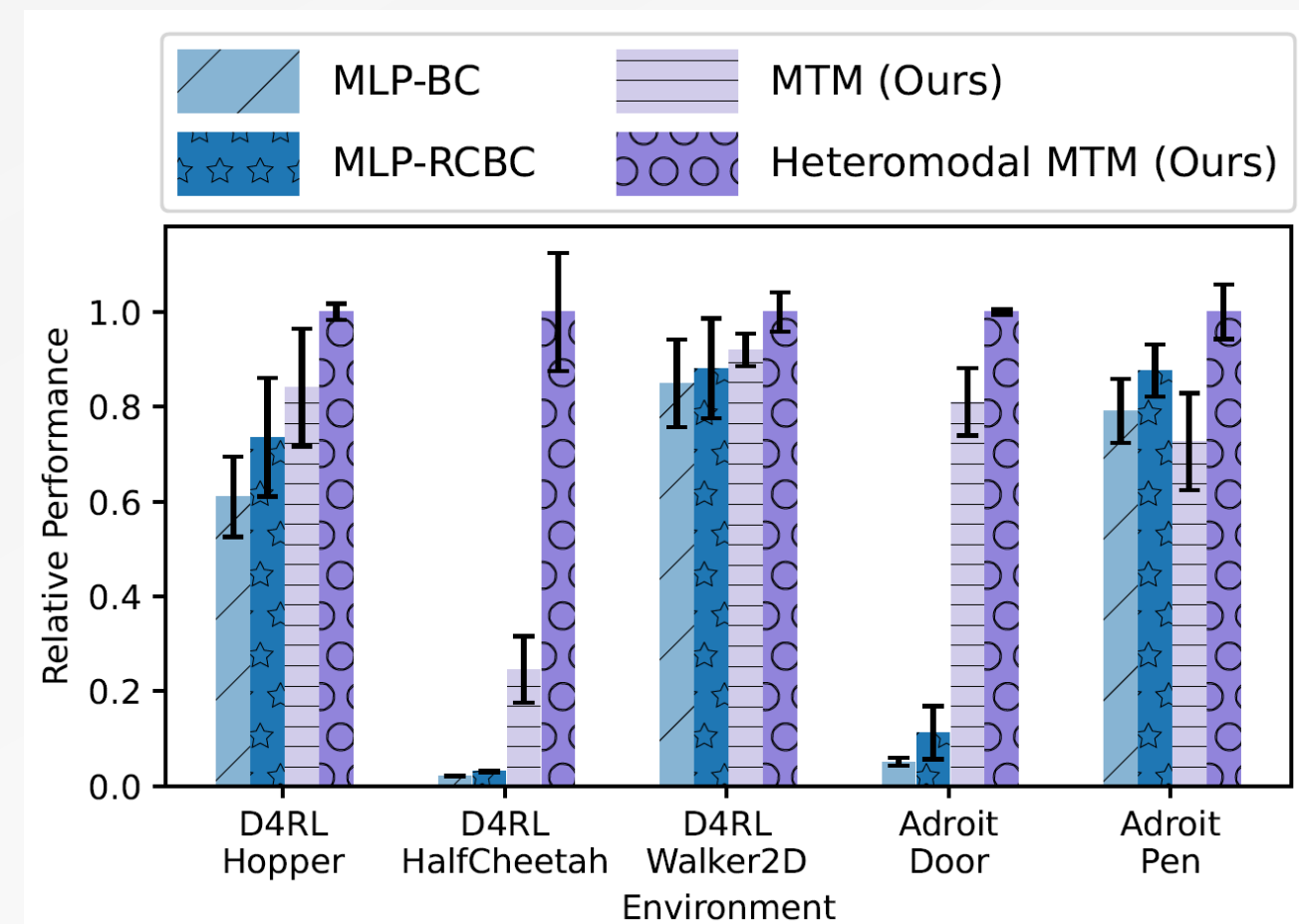
## Impact of Masking Patterns



Autoregressive random often outperforms random, and in most cases is even competitive with the specialized (or oracle) RCBC mask.

# Experiments

MTM can effectively learn from heteromodal datasets



Training a MTM models on **Expert datasets** across domains where only a **small fraction** of the data have **action** labels.

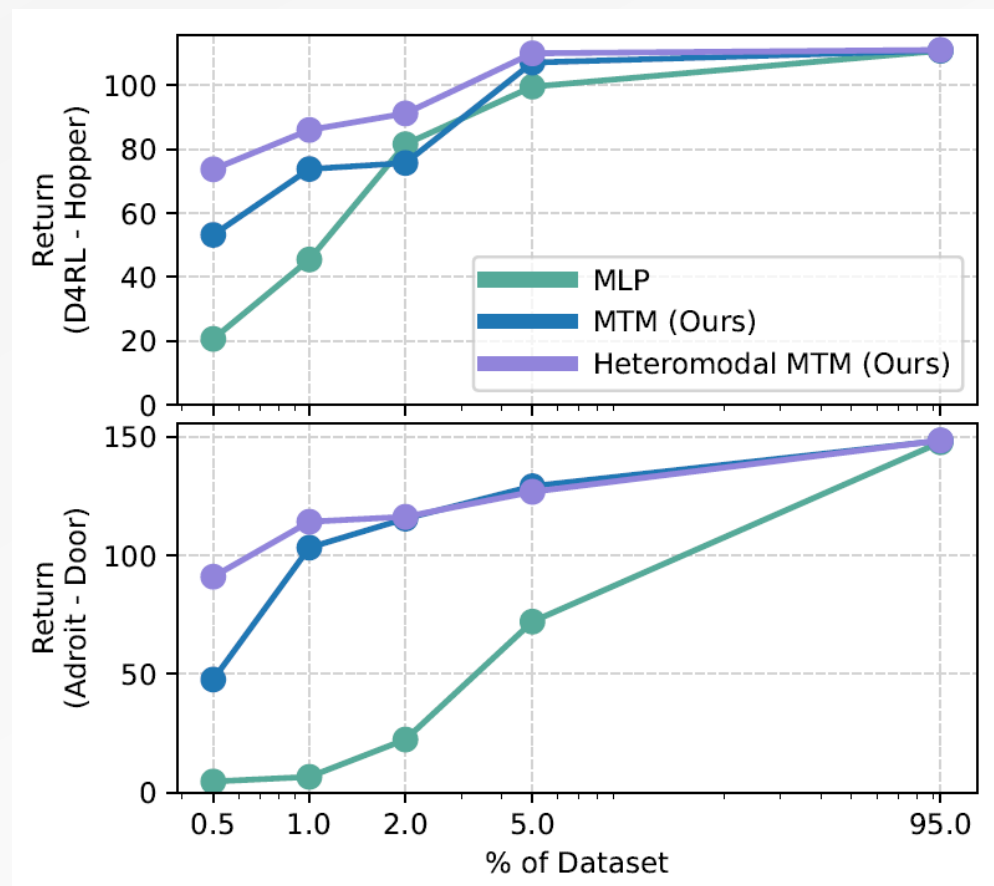
MLP and MTM: trained **only** on the subset of data with **action** labels.

Heteromodal MTM: two-stage action inference procedure.

- **predict future states** given current state and desired returns
- **predict actions** using the current state and predicted future states

# Experiments

## Dataset efficiency



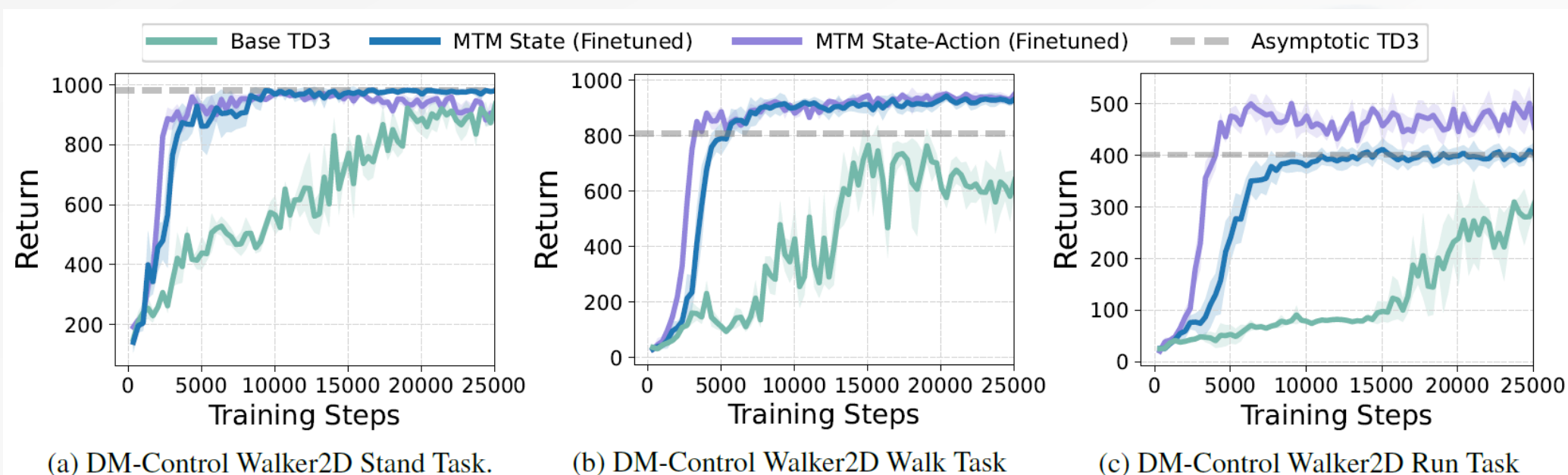
MTM is able to consistently outperform specialized MLP models in the [low data regime](#).



# Experiments

MTM Representations enable faster learning.

The agent is trained **offline** using data from the **ExORL** dataset.



Base TD3: run TD3 on the dataset

MTM State: use **state** representations

MTM State-Action: additionally use **state-action** representations for **critic**

Finetuned: end to end **finetuning** of the **representations** during training

# Conclusion

This paper introduced **MTM** as a **versatile** and effective approach for sequential decision making.

A single pretrained model can be used for different downstream purposes:

- inverse dynamics
- forward dynamics
- imitation learning
- offline RL
- representation learning

by **simply changing the masks** used at inference time.



THANKS!

